

YOUNG BOSS BOUNCE HOUSE GUIDE

How Caribbean Kids Start a
Rental Business From Scratch



FOR KIDS
WITH BIG IDEAS
AND EVEN
BIGGER GOALS

TURN FUN
INTO INCOME!

- ✓ Plan It
- ✓ Rent It
- ✓ Grow It
- ✓ Boss It

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

What You'll Learn

Six chapters. Real knowledge. Zero hype.

Why the Bounce House Business

1

Works

The real numbers and why Caribbean kids have an edge

Finding Your First Bounce House Cheap

2

Facebook Marketplace, Costco, used equipment — where to look

What to Charge and How to Get

3

Bookings

Pricing that works, where to find your first customers

Setup, Safety, and What Parents Need to

4

Know

Running a professional operation from day one

Your Money — Budget, Profit, and

5

Reinvesting

How to track earnings and grow smart

Growing from One Unit to Two and

6

Beyond

The scale-up moves that real operators use

This guide was built from real experience running an inflatable entertainment business. The numbers, the strategies, and the advice are real — not theory from a laptop. Caribbean children abroad are capable of building real businesses. This is your blueprint. Now go boss it.

CHAPTER ONE

Why the Bounce House Business Works

Real numbers. Real opportunity. Built for you.

Let's start with the truth. Most businesses take months before they make any money. The bounce house rental business is different. You buy one unit, you book one party, and you've already started earning. That first Saturday booking could put \$150 to \$300 in your pocket — more than most people earn in a full day of work.

The reason this business works so well for young people is simple: you don't need a storefront, you don't need employees, and you don't need a fancy website to get started. You need one bounce house, a phone, and the hustle to find your first customer.

\$185

Average profit per standard booking

After equipment cost, setup, and takedown — money in your pocket

Why Caribbean Kids Have a Real Edge

Caribbean culture understands celebration. Birthdays, christenings, graduations, community events — the diaspora community abroad celebrates everything. And they celebrate big. That means your customer base already knows what a bounce house is, already wants one for their next event, and already trusts someone from the community who shows up professional and prepared.

You're not selling to strangers. You're serving your own community. That's not just a business advantage — that's a Caribbean advantage.

When people book

Birthday parties, block parties, church events, school fairs, graduation parties, community festivals — year round demand in Caribbean diaspora communities

Where it works

New York, London, Toronto, Miami, Atlanta, Houston — anywhere the Caribbean community is large and celebrations happen regularly on weekends

YOUNG BOSS TRUTH

This is a weekend business. Most bookings happen Saturday and Sunday. That means school stays school, and your business stays your business. You're not choosing between the two.



CARIBBEAN ISLAND FACT

Antigua has 365 beaches — one for every day of the year. That same island spirit of abundance is what you're bringing to your business. There's always another weekend. Always another booking.

CHAPTER TWO

Finding Your First Bounce House Cheap

You don't need to spend big to start big.

The biggest mistake new operators make is spending too much on their first unit. You don't need a brand new commercial bounce house to start. You need a clean, safe, working unit at the lowest possible entry cost. Here's exactly where to look.

1**Facebook Marketplace — Your Best First Stop**

Search "bounce house" in your local Facebook Marketplace. Filter for within 50 miles. You'll find units that other operators are selling off — sometimes barely used — for \$300 to \$800. Always ask: How old is it? Does it hold air properly? Is the blower included? Can I see it inflated before buying?

2**Costco and Sam's Club — New at Low Cost**

Costco and Sam's Club sell commercial-grade bounce houses seasonally, typically between \$400 and \$900 for a solid starter unit. These are new, come with blowers, and have warranty coverage. Watch for seasonal sales in spring when party rental season starts.

3**Craigslist and OfferUp**

Same approach as Facebook Marketplace. Search "inflatable rental," "bounce house," and "party rental equipment." Operators who are closing down or upgrading their fleet often list quality units here at steep discounts.

4**GoJumpers, Jungle Jumps, and Action Air — Direct Wholesale**

These are wholesale inflatable suppliers that sell direct to operators. New commercial-grade units start at \$600 to \$1,400. If you're buying new, go here instead of retail. Search each name online to browse their current inventory and pricing.

What to Look For in a Starter Unit

Good signs

Clean stitching, no tears or patches, working blower included, holds air for 30+ minutes continuously,

Walk away from

Visible tears or stitching patches, musty or mildew smell, residential-grade thin nylon material, missing or

commercial-grade PVC material,
13x13 or larger size

broken blower, anything seller won't
inflate for you to inspect first

YOUNG BOSS MOVE

Before you buy anything, ask your parent or guardian to inspect it with you. Two sets of eyes catch more problems than one. And having a trusted adult with you when buying from a stranger is always the smart move.



CARIBBEAN ISLAND FACT

Tobago has one of the oldest protected reefs in the Western Hemisphere. It was protected in 1776. The best businesses, like the best reefs, are built to last — and that starts with choosing quality from the beginning.

What to Charge and How to Get Bookings

Price it right. Fill your calendar.

Pricing is where most new operators get it wrong. They charge too little because they're scared nobody will book them. The truth is, parents who are planning a birthday party are not looking for the cheapest option — they're looking for someone reliable who will show up on time and make the event go smoothly. Price for that.

Starter Pricing Guide

Service	What to Charge	Notes
Standard 4-hour rental	\$150 - \$200	Your core offer. Covers backyard birthday parties.
6-hour rental	\$225 - \$275	Great for block parties and longer events.
Full day (8 hrs)	\$275 - \$350	Church events, community fairs, school events.
Delivery fee	\$25 - \$50	Charge if event is more than 10 miles away.
Setup and takedown	Included	Always include — it's part of your service.

Where to Find Your First Bookings

1

Tell your community first

Your church, your parents' WhatsApp groups, your Caribbean community social media pages — these are your first customers. A simple message: "We now do bounce house rentals for birthdays and events. DM for pricing." Post a photo of your unit. That's it.

2

Facebook Groups — Caribbean community pages

Search Facebook for Caribbean community groups in your city. "Jamaicans in [city]," "Trinidad and Tobago [city]," "Caribbean parents [city]." Post your service there. These groups are full of parents who plan events and already trust community members.

3

Nextdoor and local neighborhood apps

Post your service on Nextdoor — a neighborhood app where local families look for services. "Bounce house rentals available for birthday parties and events — serving [your area]." Include one clear photo and your contact number.

4

Your first booking at a discount

Offer your very first booking at a reduced price in exchange for photos and a review. That photo of kids jumping in your bounce house becomes your marketing material for every booking after that.

THE REAL OPERATOR SECRET

The bounce house is not the product. The experience is the product. Parents are paying for a stress-free party where kids are happy and safe. Show up on time, set up clean, and be professional — and they will call you again for every party after that.

CHAPTER FOUR

Setup, Safety, and Professionalism

Run it right from day one.

Safety is not optional. It's the foundation of everything. One accident — even a small one — can end your business before it really starts. The good news is that running a safe operation is simple when you know the rules and follow them every single time.

Setup Checklist — Every Event

- ✓ Inspect the unit for tears, weak stitching, or damage before inflating
- ✓ Set up on flat, clear ground — no rocks, sprinkler heads, or debris underneath
- ✓ Stake or sandbag all anchor points — never leave the unit unsecured
- ✓ Keep the blower running continuously — never turn it off during use
- ✓ Set a maximum number of children at one time — follow manufacturer's limit
- ✓ No shoes inside the bounce house — ever
- ✓ No food, drinks, or silly string inside
- ✓ Always have an adult supervising during use
- ✓ Deflate and pack down in dry conditions — never store wet
- ✓ Wipe down and sanitize after every use before packing

What Your Parent or Guardian Needs to Know

Because you are a young entrepreneur, your parent or guardian is your business partner for the legal side of things. Here's what needs to happen before you take your first paid booking:

Business basics

Ask your parent to help you open a simple business bank account or use a Cash App business account to receive payments professionally. Keep your business money separate from your personal money from day one.

Simple rental agreement

Have customers sign a one-page rental agreement before every booking. It states the rental terms, safety rules, and that the customer is responsible for supervising children during use. Search "bounce house rental agreement template" for a free version.

PRO TIP FROM A REAL OPERATOR

The operators who last in this business are the ones who treat every booking like it's the most important one they've ever had. Clean equipment. On-time arrival. Professional communication. That's how you get referrals — and referrals are free customers.



CARIBBEAN ISLAND FACT

St. Lucia is home to the world's only drive-in volcano — Sulphur Springs. Caribbean people have always turned what seems impossible into something extraordinary. That's the same energy you bring to your business.

CHAPTER FIVE

Your Money — Budget, Profit, and Reinvesting

Know your numbers. Every. Single. Time.

The difference between a Young Boss and someone just doing a favor for family is this: a Young Boss tracks every dollar in and every dollar out. You don't have to be a math genius. You just have to know where your money goes.

Sample First-Year Money Breakdown

Item	Cost / Income	Notes
Used bounce house (starter unit)	– \$500	One-time startup cost. Facebook Marketplace find.
Cleaning supplies + extension cord	– \$40	Bucket, sanitizer, 100ft heavy-duty extension cord
First booking at discount	+ \$100	Discounted for photos and review
Bookings 2–5 at full price (\$175 avg)	+ \$700	4 weekend bookings over 4–6 weeks
Equipment paid off by	Booking 4	Every booking after that is nearly pure profit
End of first season (10 bookings)	\$1,200+	Net profit after all costs

The Reinvestment Rule

When your first unit is paid off — and it will pay off fast — split your profits three ways:

1

Save 40% — Your business savings account

This is your fund for the second bounce house. Every booking that comes in, 40 cents of every dollar goes here. Don't touch it.

2

Keep 40% — Your earnings

This is yours. You earned it. Put it in a savings account, not a spending account. Let it grow while you work.

3

Reinvest 20% — Marketing and maintenance

Simple flyers, a Facebook business page, replacement parts, cleaning supplies. Keep the business looking and running professional.

YOUNG BOSS TRUTH

Money you can see in your hand feels real. Money in a savings account feels invisible. Caribbean families who built wealth abroad understood that the invisible money is the powerful money. Save it. Let it stack. It will show up when it matters most.

Growing From One Unit to Two and Beyond

The scale-up moves real operators use.

One bounce house is a side hustle. Two bounce houses is a business. Three bounce houses is a company. The jump from one to two is the most important move you'll make — and it's simpler than you think when you've followed the money rules in chapter five.

When You're Ready to Add a Second Unit

- ✓ Your first unit is fully paid off from bookings
- ✓ You've had at least 8–10 successful bookings with zero problems
- ✓ You have repeat customers and referrals coming in without advertising
- ✓ Your business savings account has at least \$400–\$600 saved
- ✓ You can handle two events on the same Saturday with a helper

Your Second Unit Strategy

Don't buy the same unit twice. Your second unit should be different — either a combo unit with a slide (commands \$50–\$75 more per booking) or a water slide for summer events. Different units let you serve different customers and charge premium prices for the upgraded option.

Unit 1 — Standard

Your workhorse. Birthday parties, smaller backyard events. Books

Unit 2 — Combo or Water Slide

Premium option. Summer events, larger parties. Commands \$225–

every weekend. \$150-\$200 per rental.

\$300 per rental. Sets you apart from basic operators.

The Bigger Picture

The operators who make \$75,000 to \$100,000 per year from inflatables started exactly where you are — with one unit, one booking, and one community to serve. The difference between them and everyone else is that they kept going, kept reinvesting, and kept treating every customer like the most important one they've ever had.

You now have the blueprint. The rest is up to you.

WANT TO GO DEEPER? SEE THE FULL OPERATOR PLATFORM AT

tropicalbounce.com

Built by the same team behind this guide — software, scripts, and systems for serious inflatable operators



CARIBBEAN ISLAND FACT

Barbados has been independent since 1966 — building its own economy, its own identity, and its own future. That same spirit of self-determination is what you carry into every booking. You are not waiting for someone to give you an opportunity. You are building one.

YOU JUST FINISHED THE GUIDE.

Now go boss it.

This guide was built from real experience. The numbers are real. The strategies work. The only thing left is you taking the first step.

YOUR FIRST WEEK ACTION PLAN

1 Search Facebook Marketplace today

Look for bounce houses in your area. Screenshot 3 options. Show your parent or guardian.

2 Tell 5 people you're starting a bounce house business

Text 5 people in your community. Ask if they know anyone with a birthday party coming up.

3 Set your price and write it down

\$175 for a 4-hour rental. Write it on paper. Make it real. You are now a business owner.

MORE YOUNG BOSS GUIDES AT

CaribStream.io

Caribbean children abroad. Building wealth. Keeping roots.

© 2026 CaribStream.io · Diamond Media Publishing LLC · All rights reserved · caribstream.io